



Maintaining Momentum

Once you are up and running, it is vital to maintain momentum. Developing your business is an ongoing process—you will need to keep researching ideas, building products, seeking new markets, and growing your customer base.

Continual development

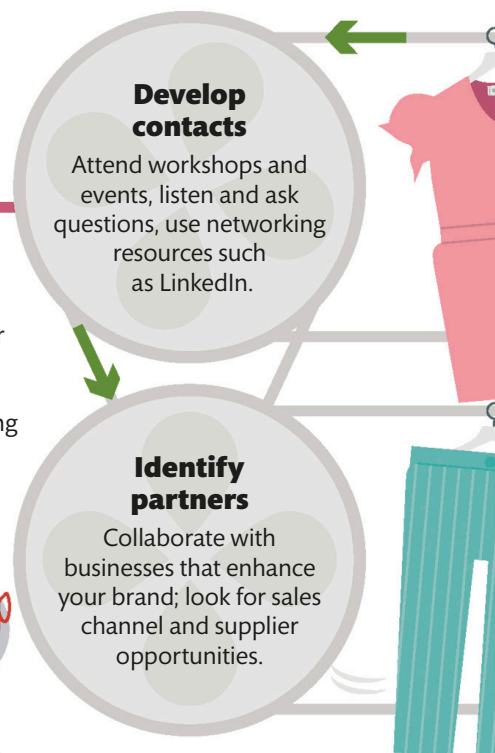
In order to achieve the objectives you set in your business plan (see pp.104–105), which can be months or even years ahead, take steps to maintain your business momentum. This means constantly trying to improve what you do and how you do it and looking for ways to reduce costs and increase profits. It also involves searching for new products and services to offer and improving those you already have. This is particularly important with your marketing activities, which play a significant role in attracting customers and sales.

There is no specific process to maintaining momentum. Instead, treat it as a fundamental objective, and share it with everyone involved in your business. To improve your

chances of achieving it, set yourself goals and measure the results. For example, you might aim to reduce the cost of your materials by 10 percent within the first year of operating, or to attract a new customer group within 6 months.

Making it happen

Maintaining momentum is important in all aspects of your business but critical in your marketing activities. Customers can easily lose interest and be tempted away by competitive rivals, so continually developing and perfecting your marketing is essential. Here are some examples of different approaches you could take.



MAKING IT WORK

- › **Borrow ideas from successful rivals** to improve how your business operates. Read trade articles in the media to discover the approaches they used.
- › **Share the need to maintain momentum** with everyone involved within the business in a simple statement. Use it as a reminder for them and yourself.
- › **Do not be blinded by short-term success**, which can easily vanish unless you continually improve and develop your business.

